

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Executive Summary

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

REPORT REFERENCE	Executive Summary
CLIENT	Acme Manufacturing
DOMAIN	Procure-to-Pay
PREPARED BY	AuroPro · Autonomous Discovery Platform
CLASSIFICATION	Confidential

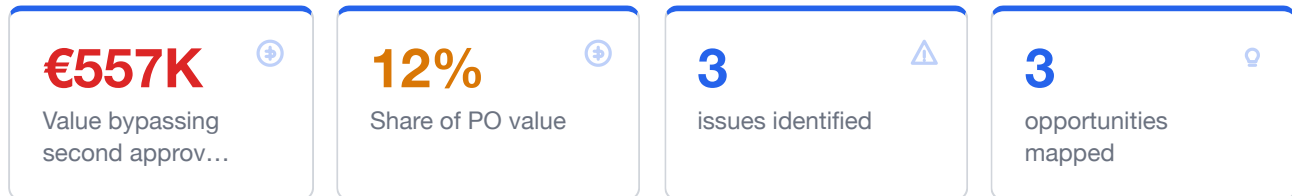
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Executive Summary

Seven purchase orders worth EUR 557,000 — 12% of total PO value — were released to suppliers on a single approval, in breach of the policy requiring a second Finance sign-off above EUR 50,000.

1 At a glance



1.1 Situation & opportunity

The situation

A review of the purchase-order export against the procurement policy surfaced two distinct control gaps. First, 7 POs totalling EUR 557,000 were flagged `single_approval_only`, representing 12% of total PO value; the policy states that "Any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager AND a second approval from Finance before it is released to the supplier," yet the export records these at amounts of 54000, 61000, 67000, 72000, 88000, 95000 and 120000 — all above the EUR 50,000 threshold. Second, 3 POs worth EUR 216,000 were raised after goods were ordered (`po_before_order = no`), accounting for 4.7% of total PO value, despite the policy stating that "Maverick spend — ordering without a purchase order — is not permitted under any circumstances." Notably, all 3 of these maverick POs were also among the single-approval cases, concentrating the highest control risk in a small set of transactions. The single largest PO in the dataset is EUR 150,000.

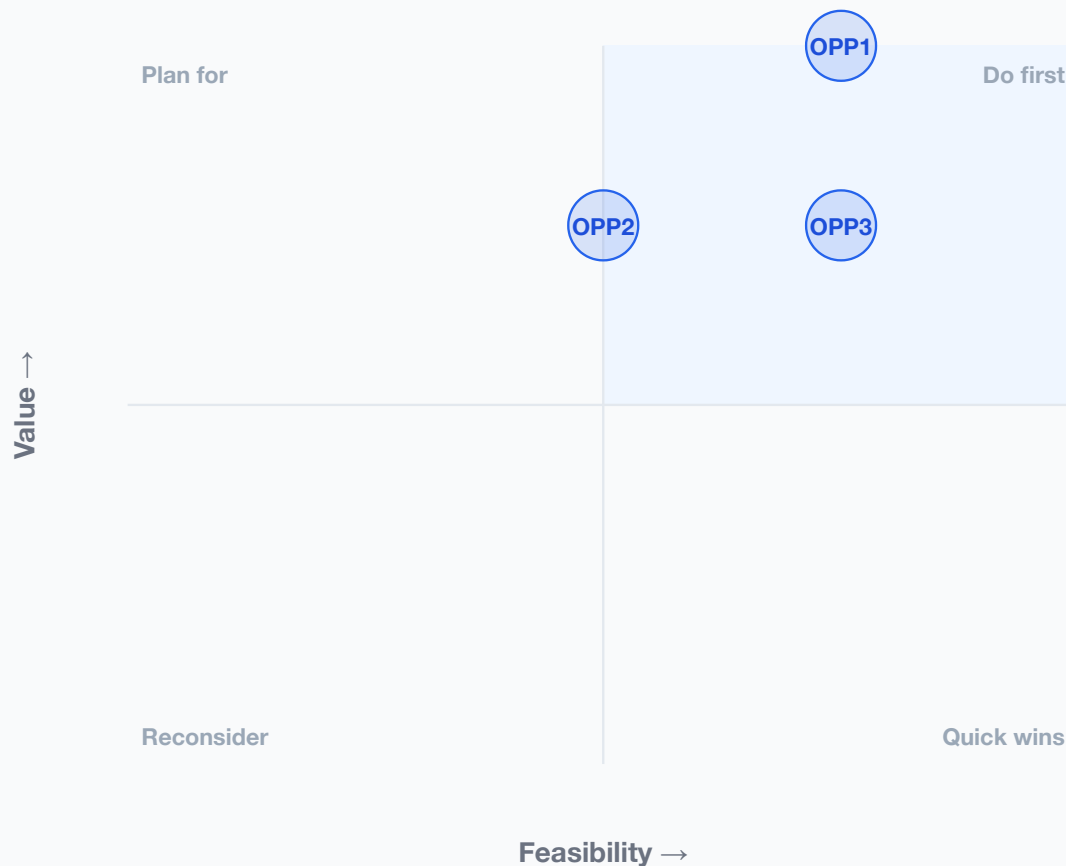
The opportunity

The exposure is concentrated and addressable: just 7 transactions drive the EUR 557,000 second-approval gap, and the 3 maverick POs sit entirely inside that same set. The immediate priority is to validate and remediate these overlapping high-value cases, then close the control that allowed POs above EUR 50,000 to release to suppliers without the required Finance sign-off. Because the policy text "never

names an exception/remediation owner," assigning clear accountability for review and corrective action is the foundational step before any systematic enforcement can be relied upon.

2 Where to start

WHERE EACH OPPORTUNITY SITS ON VALUE VERSUS FEASIBILITY



HITL WORKFLOW

High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off

The procurement policy requires high-value purchase orders to receive a second, mandatory Finance sign-off before they are released to a supplier. Ev...

HITL WORKFLOW

Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy

Maverick spend — purchases committed with suppliers before a purchase order (PO) is raised and approved — undermines the procurement policy's control...

HITL WORKFLOW

Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches

The procurement control environment currently lacks a defined owner accountable for handling exceptions and remediating control breaches. When a purc...

3 What we read

Purchase Order Export, Procurement Policy. Every figure in this assessment is computed from these sources and traces back to them.

Read on: the Current State, the issues found, and the recommended opportunities.



REPORT 01 OF 06

Current State Assessment

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

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Current State Assessment

How Procure-to-Pay runs today at Acme Manufacturing. A factual baseline of the process, the systems that support it, and how information is structured — stated as fact, no judgements.

1 Domain overview

1.1 Context and scope

This section documents the current state of the procurement purchase order process, governed by the procurement policy and evidenced by the purchase order export. The policy sets two operative control points: all purchase orders must be raised in the procurement system before goods are ordered, and any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager and a second approval from Finance before release to the supplier. The export records two distinct `approval_status` values: `approved` and `single_approval_only`.

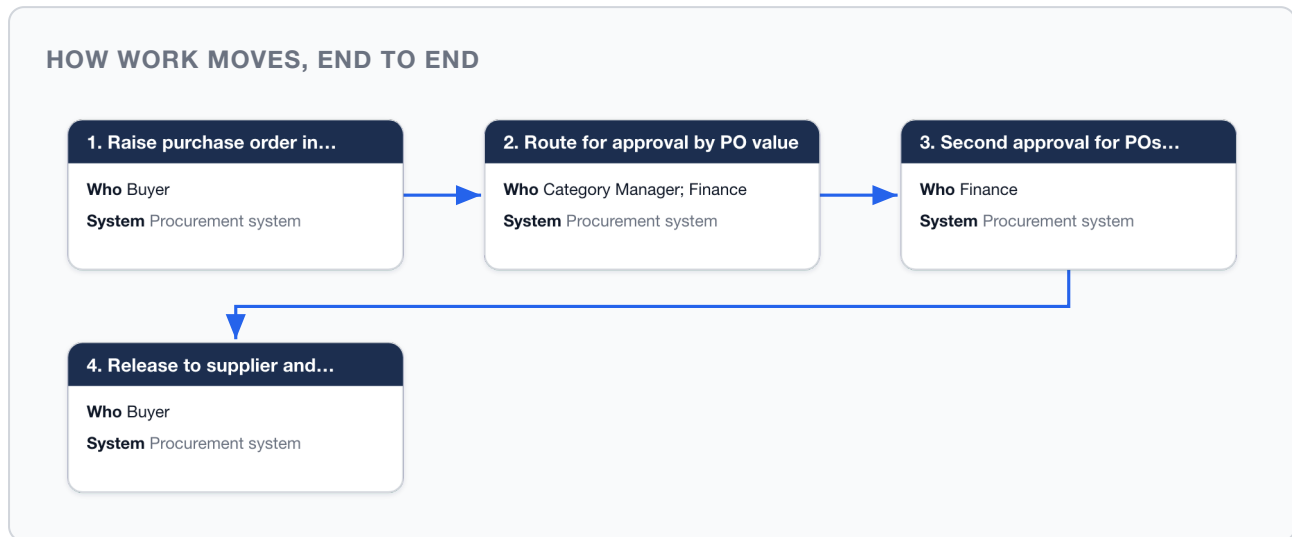
The process runs from raising a purchase order in the procurement system, through approval routing keyed to PO value, to release to the supplier and ordering of goods. The policy requires the PO to be raised before goods are ordered. POs above EUR 50,000 follow a two-approval path (Category Manager plus Finance); other POs follow a single approval path. The export shows seven POs carrying the status `single_approval_only` with a combined value of EUR 557,000, representing 12 percent of total PO value, and three POs recorded as `po_before_order` equal to no with a combined value of EUR 216,000, representing 4.7 percent of total PO value. All three of the `po_before_order` equal to no POs also carry the `single_approval_only` status.

1.2 Volume baseline



2 Process flow

The end-to-end flow, who performs each step and on which system:



STEP	PERFORMED BY	SYSTEM	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Raise purchase order in procurement system	Buyer	Procurement system	A buyer raises the purchase order in the procurement system before goods are ordered. The policy states all purchase orders must be raised in the procurement system before goods are ordered.
2. Route for approval by PO value	Category Manager; Finance	Procurement system	The purchase order is routed for approval. Any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager and a second approval from Finance before it is released to the supplier. The export records two distinct approval_status values: approved and single_approval_only.
3. Second approval for POs above EUR 50,000	Finance	Procurement system	For purchase orders above EUR 50,000, a second approval from Finance is required before release to the supplier. The export note for second approval reads count zero, no matching lines.
4. Release to supplier and order goods	Buyer	Procurement system	Once approval is complete, the purchase order is released to the supplier and goods are ordered. The policy states approval must be obtained before the PO is released to the supplier, and that the PO must be raised before goods are ordered.

3 Process inventory

Each stage of the process in detail — how it runs today, who performs it, and on which system.

Raising the purchase order

Buyer · Procurement system

Policy point one states all purchase orders must be raised in the procurement system before goods are ordered. The export records `po_before_order` with two values: yes and no. Policy point four states that maverick spend — ordering without a purchase order — is not permitted under any circumstances.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Approval routing by value threshold

Category Manager; Finance · Procurement system

Policy point two states any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager and a second approval from Finance before it is released to the supplier. The export records two distinct `approval_status` values: approved and `single_approval_only`.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Second approval evidence

Finance · Procurement system

The export lists seven `single_approval_only` POs at amounts 54000, 61000, 67000, 72000, 88000, 95000, 120000 — all above 50000 — totalling EUR 557,000, equal to 12 percent of total PO value. The export second-approval note reads count zero, no matching lines.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Maverick spend records

Buyer · Procurement system

The export records three POs with `po_before_order` equal to no, totalling EUR 216,000, equal to 4.7 percent of total PO value. All three of these POs also carry the `single_approval_only` status, restated verbatim from the export as `po_before_order=no & single_approval_only`: count 3, sum 216000.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

4 Ownership map

4.1 RACI matrix

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBLE	ACCOUNTABLE
Raise purchase order before goods are ordered	Buyer	Buyer
First approval for POs above EUR 50,000	Category Manager	Category Manager
Second approval for POs above EUR 50,000 before release	Finance	Finance

5 System inventory

SYSTEM	ROLE	SYSTEM OF RECORD FOR
Procurement system	System in which purchase orders are raised and routed for approval before goods are ordered	Purchase order records, approval_status, po_before_order
Purchase order export	Extract of purchase order records used for the figures in this section	PO transaction lines, approval_status counts, po_before_order counts

5.1 System profiles

Each system that supports this process — what it is, how it is used, who owns it, and the constraints observed.

Procurement system

Records purchase orders and applies approval routing

How it's used. Buyers raise purchase orders before goods are ordered; POs above EUR 50,000 require Category Manager approval and a second Finance approval before release to the supplier.

Ownership & access. Buyers, Category Manager, Finance

Observed constraints. The policy text describing the approval requirement does not name an exception or remediation owner.

5.2 Information format & structure

The patterns the source information follows — this drives how it can be ingested and reasoned over.

PATTERN	DESCRIPTION	WHERE IT APPEARS
approval_status = approved	Purchase order carrying the approved status.	226 rows in the export
approval_status = single_approval_only	Purchase order carrying the single_approval_only status, combined value EUR 557,000.	Amounts 54000, 61000, 67000, 72000, 88000, 95000, 120000
po_before_order = yes	Purchase order raised before goods were ordered.	230 rows in the export
po_before_order = no	Purchase order where goods were ordered without a prior PO, combined value EUR 216,000.	Three POs, all also single_approval_only

6 Handoff map

How work crosses between steps and systems — each handoff is where information changes hands or format.



- Raise purchase order (Buyer) → First approval (Category Manager) (*Procurement system routing by PO value*)
- First approval (Category Manager) → Second approval (Finance) (*Procurement system routing for POs above EUR 50,000*)
- Second approval (Finance) → Release to supplier and order goods (Buyer) (*Release to supplier after approval*)

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Pain Points & Opportunities

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

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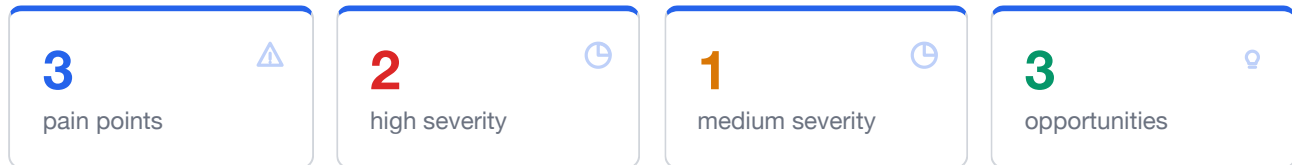
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1	Issues at a glance
2	Root cause
3	Pain points in detail
4	Appendix — evidence register

Pain Points & Opportunities

The issues found in the discovery, ranked by business impact, each mapped to a recommended opportunity.

1 Issues at a glance



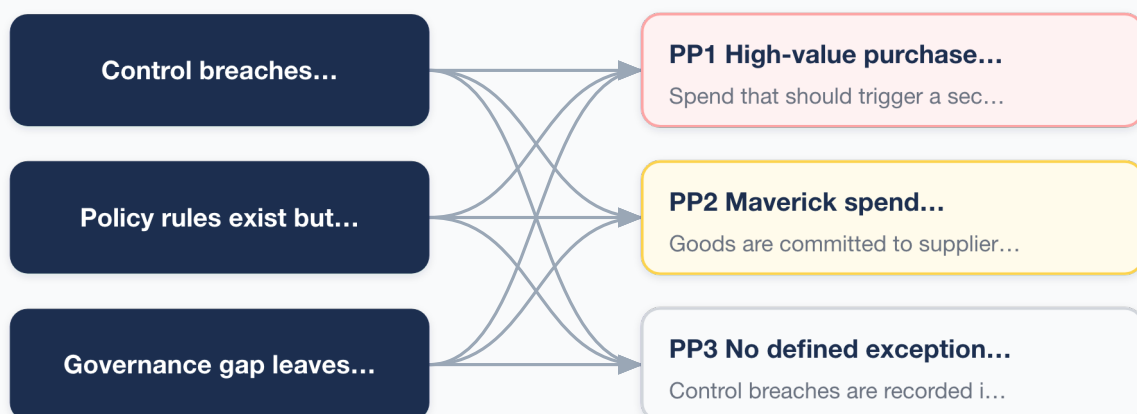
ISSUES RANKED BY BUSINESS IMPACT (MOST MATERIAL FIRST)



2 Root cause

How the issues found trace back to shared structural causes:

HOW THE ISSUES TRACE BACK TO SHARED CAUSES



Left: structural causes. Right: the pain points each one drives.

Control breaches concentrate in the same transactions. All 3 maverick POs (ordered before a PO was raised) are also within the 7 single_approval_only POs, showing that the same transactions defeat both the PO-first control and the dual-approval control simultaneously rather than being independent failures.

Policy rules exist but are not system-enforced. Both the EUR 50,000 dual-approval threshold and the PO-before-order rule are clearly stated in policy, yet the export shows transactions passing through in 'approved' status despite violating them — indicating reliance on manual discipline rather than preventive system controls.

Governance gap leaves breaches unowned. The policy defines what is required but names no exception or remediation owner, so the breaches surfaced in the data have no accountable closure path, allowing them to persist.

3 Pain points in detail

PP
01

High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off

HIGH SEVERITY

APPROVAL CONTROL BREAKDOWN

Procurement policy requires that any purchase order above EUR 50,000 receive approval from the Category Manager AND a second approval from Finance before release to the supplier. The purchase order export shows 7 POs flagged as single_approval_only, every one of which sits above the EUR 50,000 threshold (amounts of 54,000; 61,000; 67,000; 72,000; 88,000; 95,000; 120,000). These were released without the required second approval.

7

SINGLE-APPROVAL
POS

€557K

VALUE BYPASSING
SECOND APPROVAL

12%

SHARE OF PO VALUE

€150K

LARGEST SINGLE PO

Single-approval-only POs against the EUR 50,000 dual-approval threshold

All 7 single_approval_only POs exceed the EUR 50,000 policy threshold that requires a second Finance approval

FLAGGED AMOUNT (EUR)	ABOVE EUR 50,000 THRESHOLD	REQUIRED CONTROL
54,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance
61,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance
67,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance

FLAGGED AMOUNT (EUR)	ABOVE EUR 50,000 THRESHOLD	REQUIRED CONTROL
72,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance
88,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance
95,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance
120,000	Yes	Category Manager + Finance

Amounts as listed in the purchase order export for single_approval_only rows; all exceed the EUR 50,000 policy threshold.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Root cause: The mandatory dual-approval rule for spend above EUR 50,000 is not enforced as a hard control in the procurement system, allowing high-value POs to be released on a single approval. The policy itself never names an exception or remediation owner, so there is no defined path to catch or correct these cases.

BUSINESS IMPACT

EUR 557,000 of purchase value — 12% of total PO value — has been committed to suppliers without the Finance approval the policy mandates, leaving the organisation exposed to uncontrolled high-value commitments and weakened segregation of duties.

ADDRESSED BY

OPP1 — see the Opportunity Portfolio.

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

PP
02

Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy

HIGH SEVERITY

PROCESS COMPLIANCE BREACH

Policy states that all purchase orders must be raised in the procurement system before goods are ordered, and that maverick spend — ordering without a purchase order — is not permitted under any circumstances. The export records 3 POs where po_before_order = no, meaning goods were ordered before the PO existed. Notably, all 3 of these maverick POs are also among the single_approval_only set.

3

MAVERICK POS

€216K

MAVERICK SPEND
VALUE

4.7%

SHARE OF PO VALUE

3

ALSO SINGLE-
APPROVAL

Maverick spend overlap with approval gap

All maverick POs also bypassed the second approval

CONTROL BREACHED	PO COUNT	VALUE (EUR)
Ordered before PO raised (po_before_order = no)	3	216,000
Same POs also single_approval_only	3	216,000

Counts and value as recorded in the purchase order export for po_before_order = no rows.

Source: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Root cause: There is no preventive control stopping an order being placed before a PO is raised, so the 'PO-first' rule relies on buyer discipline rather than system enforcement. The overlap with single-approval cases indicates the same orders that skip the PO step also skip the approval gate.

BUSINESS IMPACT

EUR 216,000 of spend — 4.7% of total PO value — was committed without a prior purchase order, with the same 3 transactions simultaneously bypassing the second approval, compounding the control gap.

ADDRESSED BY

OPP3 — see the Opportunity Portfolio.

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

PP
03

No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches

MEDIUM SEVERITY

GOVERNANCE GAP

The procurement policy sets out the dual-approval and PO-first rules but never names an exception or remediation owner. As a result, the single-approval and maverick cases identified in the export have no defined path for review, escalation or correction. The data shows zero matching lines for any documented second-approval remediation.

2

DISTINCT APPROVAL STATUSES

7

SINGLE-APPROVAL ROWS

3

MAVERICK ROWS

Approval status and PO-timing distribution

Distinct values recorded in the export

FIELD	VALUE	COUNT
approval_status	approved	226
approval_status	single_approval_only	7
po_before_order	yes	230
po_before_order	no	3

Distribution as stated in the purchase order export distinct-value summary.

Source: Purchase Order Export

Root cause: The policy defines the rules but not the accountability for handling breaches, leaving non-compliant POs to remain in 'approved' status with no party responsible for closing them out.

BUSINESS IMPACT

The 7 single-approval and 3 maverick POs already identified have no owner to remediate them, meaning the breaches sit unaddressed and are likely to recur without governance change.

ADDRESSED BY

OPP2 — see the Opportunity Portfolio.

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

4 Appendix — evidence register

Every finding traced to the source it rests on, with the confidence tier.

FINDING	SOURCE	EVIDENCE TYPE	KEY DATA POINT	CONFIDENCE
7 POs were released on a single approval, all above the EUR 50,000 dual-approval threshold	purchase-order-export	data + policy	single_approval_only POs at amounts 54000, 61000, 67000, 72000, 88000, 95000, 120000 — all >50000	VERIFIED
Single-approval POs total EUR 557,000, equal to 12% of total PO value	purchase-order-export	aggregate	7 single_approval_only POs; EUR 557,000; 12% of total PO value	VERIFIED

FINDING	SOURCE	EVIDENCE TYPE	KEY DATA POINT	CONFIDENCE
Policy mandates Category Manager AND Finance approval above EUR 50,000 before supplier release	procurement-policy	policy quote	"Any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager AND a second approval from Finance before it is released to the supplier."	VERIFIED
3 POs were raised after goods were ordered (maverick spend), totalling EUR 216,000 (4.7% of value)	purchase-order-export	aggregate	po_before_order=no & single_approval_only: count 3, sum 216000	VERIFIED
All 3 maverick POs are also single_approval_only	purchase-order-export	overlap	Maverick POs that are also single_approval_only = 3	VERIFIED
Policy prohibits ordering without a purchase order under any circumstances	procurement-policy	policy quote	"Maverick spend — ordering without a purchase order — is not permitted under any circumstances."	VERIFIED
Only 2 distinct approval statuses exist; no remediation/exception status or owner is defined	purchase-order-export	data + policy gap	approval_status distinct: approved (226), single_approval_only (7); second approval: count 0, no matching lines	VERIFIED
Largest single PO in the dataset is EUR 150,000	purchase-order-export	data point	Largest single PO (max amount) = EUR 150,000	VERIFIED

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Transformation Recommendation

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

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4.4	Strategic readiness
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Transformation Recommendation

Which opportunities to pursue, in what order, by value and feasibility.

1 Transformation intent

The target state is a procurement control environment in which every purchase order is demonstrably raised before goods are ordered and every high-value order passes through the dual-approval gate the policy already mandates. Today the export shows two distinct approval statuses — approved and single_approval_only — with 7 purchase orders worth EUR 557,000 (12 percent of total PO value) released on a single approval, despite the policy requirement that any order above EUR 50,000 carry both Category Manager and Finance sign-off. Separately, 3 maverick orders worth EUR 216,000 (4.7 percent of total PO value) were placed without a prior purchase order, and all 3 of those maverick orders are also among the single-approval population — meaning the same lines breach two distinct policy controls at once. In the target state, the single_approval_only status is eliminated for orders above the threshold, maverick spend is structurally prevented rather than detected after the fact, and the policy's open gap — that it never names an exception or remediation owner — is closed so every breach has an accountable role. The largest single order in the dataset, at EUR 150,000, illustrates the exposure: a single order of that size currently can, under observed practice, reach a supplier on one approval.

1.1 Guiding principles

P1

Strategic direction

Control-first remediation

P2

Sequencing

Sequencing is driven by where the breaches concentrate and how severe each is.

P3

Readiness

Readiness is strong because the controls are already written into the procurement policy: the EUR 50,000 dual-approval rule and the PO-before-order requirement both exist on paper...

2 Value vs. feasibility

WHERE EACH OPPORTUNITY SITS ON VALUE VERSUS FEASIBILITY

**DO FIRST**

High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off

Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy

Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches

PLAN FOR

None in this quadrant

CONSIDER*None in this quadrant***DEPRIORITISE***None in this quadrant***3 Recommendations**

Each opportunity as a recommendation — what it addresses, the phased actions, and what success looks like.

**R
01****High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off****CRITICAL PRIORITY****HITL WORKFLOW**

Addresses PP1 | Delivers OPP1

The procurement policy requires high-value purchase orders to receive a second, mandatory Finance sign-off before they are released to a supplier. Evidence in the purchase order export shows orders being released on a single approval, meaning the Finance control point defined in the policy is being bypassed in practice. This opportunity introduces a human-in-the-loop approval gate that holds any order meeting the high-value criteria until the required Finance approver has signed off, closing the gap between the documented control and day-to-day execution. The intent is not to add friction to routine, low-value buying but to ensure the specific orders the policy already designates for dual control cannot proceed without it.

Phased actions

- H1** A staff member raises a purchase requisition and submits it for approval, unchanged from today.
- H1** At the point of first approval the order value is automatically evaluated against the high-value criterion defined in the procurement policy.

- H1** Orders meeting the high-value criterion are routed to a Finance approver and held. The order cannot be released until the Finance sign-off is recorded, enforcing the dual control the policy already mandates.
- H1** Once both the first approval and the Finance sign-off are present, the order is released to the supplier. Orders below the threshold continue to flow on a single approval with no added friction.

Success criteria

Zero high-value purchase orders released without a recorded Finance sign-off

Proportion of high-value orders correctly routed to the Finance gate

Reduction in control breaches identified retrospectively during reconciliation and audit

Time from first approval to Finance sign-off for high-value orders

Number of blocked-release attempts logged and resolved

DEPENDENCY

Prerequisite for Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches.

R
02

Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy

CRITICAL PRIORITY

HITL WORKFLOW

Addresses PP3 | Delivers OPP2

Maverick spend — purchases committed with suppliers before a purchase order (PO) is raised and approved — undermines the procurement policy's control framework. When invoices arrive against commitments that were never sanctioned through the PO workflow, the organisation loses the ability to enforce spend thresholds, approval hierarchies and budget checks at the point of commitment. This opportunity establishes a human-in-the-loop control that detects off-policy commitments, routes them to an accountable reviewer, and either retrospectively validates or escalates them, while feeding the pattern back to prevent recurrence. The aim is to move enforcement from after-the-fact invoice reconciliation to the point at which spend is committed, restoring the policy's intended "no PO, no commitment" discipline.

Phased actions

- H1** Incoming invoices and supplier commitments are checked against the purchase-order record to identify any spend committed without a pre-existing, approved PO.
- H1** Any detected maverick commitment is routed to an accountable reviewer with the policy clause it breaches and the spend detail, for a decision to validate retrospectively or

escalate.

- H1** The reviewer's decision is logged against the requester and supplier so repeat off-policy behaviour is visible, and the case feeds reporting that drives corrective action and prevention.

Success criteria

Reduction in invoices arriving without a matching, pre-approved purchase order

Reduction in retrospective POs raised solely to clear an already-committed invoice

Proportion of off-policy commitments detected and routed to human review rather than discovered at payment

Reduction in repeat off-policy commitments by the same requester or supplier

DEPENDENCY

Prerequisite for Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches.

**R
03**

Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches

CRITICAL PRIORITY

HITL WORKFLOW

Addresses PP2 | Delivers OPP3

The procurement control environment currently lacks a defined owner accountable for handling exceptions and remediating control breaches. When a purchase order violates a policy control — for example, exceeding an approval threshold, missing a required approval step, or being split to evade limits — there is no named role responsible for catching the breach, deciding on the appropriate response, and driving the remediation to closure. As a result, breaches are detected inconsistently (if at all), no audit trail of the resolution is maintained, and the same control gaps recur. This opportunity establishes a human-in-the-loop exception and remediation workflow with a clearly assigned owner, a defined intake-to-closure path, and a documented decision record for every breach.

Phased actions

- H1** A control breach — threshold exceedance, missing approval, or split order — is routed into a single exception intake queue the moment it is detected, creating a traceable case record.
- H1** A designated exception/remediation owner reviews each case, classifies severity, and records a remediation decision — accept with justification, correct the order, or escalate. Every decision is captured in a structured...

- H1** The owner drives corrective action to completion, and the case is closed only with a documented outcome. Recurring breach patterns feed back into control tuning and policy updates.

Success criteria

Percentage of detected control breaches assigned to a named owner (target: all)

Percentage of breach cases closed with a documented remediation decision

Time from breach detection to case closure

Reduction in recurring breaches of the same control type over time

Audit-trail completeness for adjudicated exceptions

DEPENDENCY

Requires High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off, Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy first.

4 Sequencing & readiness

4.1 Prioritization rationale

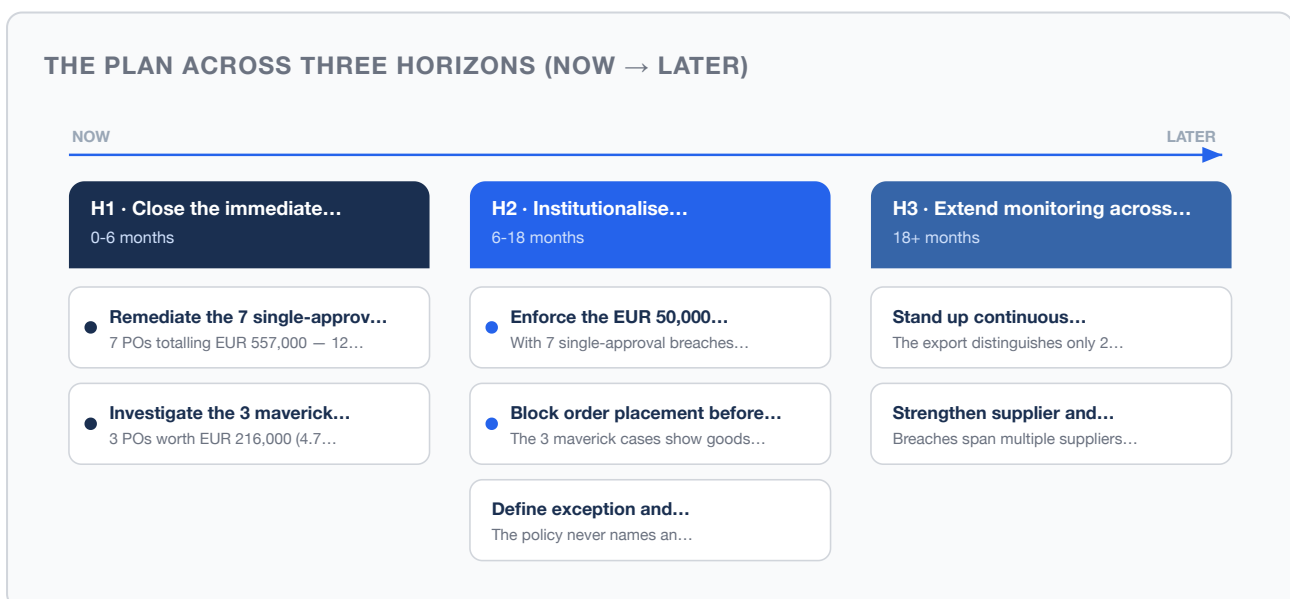
Each opportunity assessed across three readiness dimensions. The rating (high / medium / low) is followed by the reason, so the sequence is defensible rather than asserted.

OPPORTUNITY	DATA READINESS	TECHNICAL COMPLEXITY	OPERATIONAL READINESS
High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off	ORDER VALUE AND APPROVAL HISTORY ARE AVAILABLE IN THE PURCHASE ORDER EXPORT, WHICH EVIDENCES THE CURRENT SINGLE-APPROVAL RELEASES. CONFIRM THAT ORDER-VALUE FIELDS ARE COMPLETE AND CONSISTENT SO THE HIGH-VALUE CHECK CLASSIFIES RELIABLY.	LOW TO MODERATE. THE CONTROL REUSES EXISTING PROCUREMENT APPROVAL AND ROUTING FUNCTIONALITY, ADDING A VALUE-BASED CONDITIONAL HOLD AND A MANDATORY SECOND APPROVER. THE MAIN EFFORT IS IN ACCURATE THRESHOLD CONFIGURATION, RELIABLE ORDER-VALUE DATA, AND A RELEASE-BLOCK EVENT LOG RATHER THAN IN NEW SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT.	FINANCE MUST BE READY TO STAFF THE APPROVAL GATE WITH APPROPRIATE COVER SO HELD ORDERS ARE CLEARED PROMPTLY. REQUESTERS AND FIRST-LINE APPROVERS NEED CLEAR COMMUNICATION THAT HIGH-VALUE ORDERS WILL NOW BE HELD PENDING FINANCE SIGN-OFF.
Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy	PURCHASE-ORDER RECORDS AND THE PROCUREMENT POLICY ARE AVAILABLE TO ANCHOR DETECTION CRITERIA; HOWEVER, NO VERIFIED MEASURE OF MAVERICK-SPEND VOLUME OR VALUE WAS SUPPLIED, SO A BASELINE MUST BE CAPTURED BEFORE IMPACT CAN BE QUANTIFIED.	MODERATE the core requirement is reliable matching of invoices and supplier commitments against the purchase-order record to flag missing pre-approved POs, plus a routing and logging workflow for human review. Complexity is driven by data linkage quality between finance and procurement systems rather than by advanced technology.	A HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP REVIEW STEP DEPENDS ON AN ACCOUNTABLE REVIEWER ROLE, CLEAR POLICY-BASED DECISION CRITERIA, AND A FEEDBACK CHANNEL TO BUDGET HOLDERS all of which need to be confirmed before go-live.

OPPORTUNITY	DATA READINESS	TECHNICAL COMPLEXITY	OPERATIONAL READINESS
Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches	THE PROCUREMENT POLICY PROVIDES THE CONTROL DEFINITIONS AND APPROVAL THRESHOLDS, AND THE PURCHASE ORDER EXPORT PROVIDES THE TRANSACTIONAL POPULATION AGAINST WHICH BREACHES CAN BE IDENTIFIED AND VALIDATED. NO BREACH-VOLUME OR EXPOSURE METRICS ARE AVAILABLE IN THE VERIFIED FACTS, SO QUANTIFICATION WILL REQUIRE BASELINING ONCE MONITORING IS LIVE.	LOW TO MODERATE. THE CORE CHANGE IS ORGANISATIONAL defining an owner role, intake queue, and case record — supported by rule-based control checks applied to existing procurement data. No advanced modelling is required; complexity lies in accurately codifying policy controls and integrating the case workflow with current procurement systems.	REQUIRES MANAGEMENT MANDATE TO ESTABLISH THE OWNER ROLE WITH CLEAR DECISION RIGHTS, PLUS A DOCUMENTED INTAKE-TO-CLOSURE PROCEDURE. THE PILOT-ON-HISTORICAL-DATA APPROACH ALLOWS THE WORKFLOW TO BE VALIDATED BEFORE LIVE ROLLOUT.

4.2 Implementation roadmap

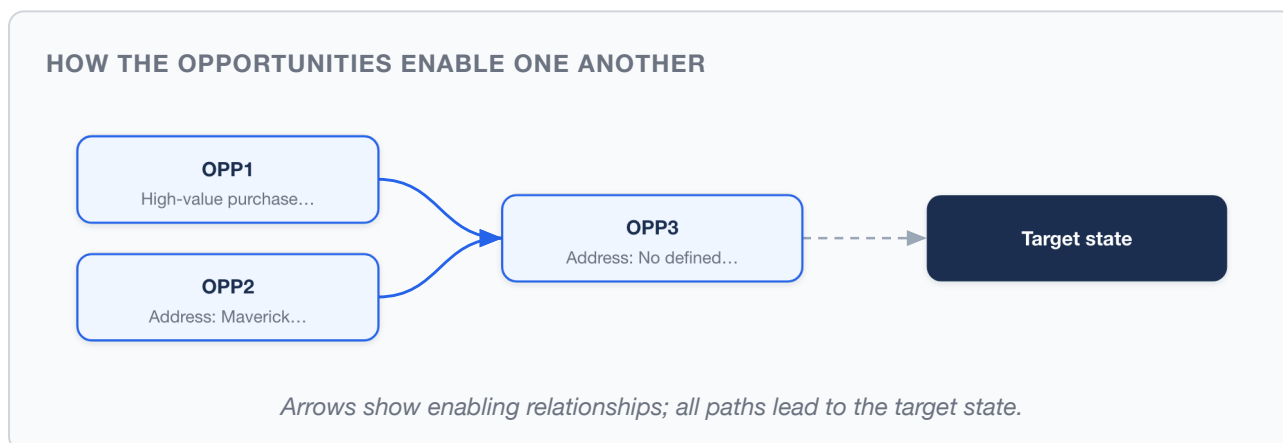
The recommendations sequenced across three horizons (now → later).



4.3 Sequencing rationale

Sequencing is driven by where the breaches concentrate and how severe each is. The highest-value exposure is the EUR 557,000 of single-approval releases (12 percent of PO value), so enforcing the dual-approval gate that the policy already mandates is the first move. Because all 3 maverick orders (EUR 216,000) are also `single_approval_only`, the maverick fix and the approval-gate fix touch the same order-entry control point and are best implemented together rather than serially, avoiding a partial fix that leaves the second breach open. Closing the policy's ownership gap — it never names an exception or remediation owner — underpins both enforcement steps, since a gate that triggers exceptions needs an accountable role to resolve them.

Dependencies: The maverick-spend remediation and the dual-approval enforcement share the same order-entry control point and the same 3 overlapping orders, so they are interdependent and should be addressed in one pass. Both depend on first closing the policy ownership gap, since enforced gates generate exceptions that require a named accountable role to clear.



4.4 Strategic readiness

Readiness is strong because the controls are already written into the procurement policy: the EUR 50,000 dual-approval rule and the PO-before-order requirement both exist on paper, and the breaches are precisely quantified from the export — 7 single-approval POs (EUR 557,000), 3 maverick POs (EUR 216,000), and 2 distinct approval statuses. The transformation is therefore primarily one of enforcement and accountability rather than new policy design. The principal readiness gap is the absence of a named exception or remediation owner in the policy, which must be resolved for the enforced gates to be operable.

5 Success metrics

How to measure delivery once live — the baseline today and the directional target.

METRIC	WHAT IT MEASURES	TARGET
Dual-approval compliance rate for high-value POs	Share of purchase orders above the EUR 50,000 policy threshold that carry both Category Manager and Finance approval before release, measured against the single_approval_only population (currently 7 POs, EUR 557,000).	Increase toward full compliance; drive single_approval_only count to zero for above-threshold orders
Value bypassing second approval	Total EUR value and percentage of total PO value released on a single approval (currently EUR 557,000, 12 percent of total PO value).	Decrease the bypassing value and its 12 percent share toward zero
Maverick spend rate	Count and EUR value of purchase orders where po_before_order = no, expressed against total PO value (currently 3 POs, EUR 216,000, 4.7 percent of total PO value).	Decrease toward zero maverick orders
Dual-breach overlap	Count of orders that are simultaneously maverick and single_approval_only (currently 3 of 3 maverick orders).	Eliminate the overlap by closing both controls at the order-entry point
Control ownership coverage	Share of policy control breaches that have a named accountable role for exception handling and remediation, addressing the documented gap that the policy never names an exception/remediation owner.	Increase to full coverage — every breach type mapped to an accountable role

6 Risk register

The delivery risks, how likely and how serious each is, and how it is mitigated.

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION	OWNER
High-value orders continue to reach suppliers on a single approval, as observed in 7 POs worth EUR 557,000, exposing the organisation to unreviewed commitments including orders as large as EUR 150,000.	HIGH	HIGH	Enforce the existing policy rule — Category Manager AND Finance approval above EUR 50,000 — as a system-level gate that blocks release without the second approval.	Finance lead / Head of Procurement
Maverick spend continues, with goods ordered before a purchase order exists, as seen in 3 orders worth EUR 216,000.	MEDIUM	HIGH	Make a raised purchase order a precondition for ordering, removing the practical ability to commit spend ahead of the PO.	Head of Procurement
Breaches go unremediated because the policy never names an exception or remediation owner, leaving accountability undefined.	HIGH	MEDIUM	Amend the procurement policy to name an accountable role for each breach type and a remediation path.	Procurement policy owner
The same orders breach two controls at once — all 3 maverick orders are also single_approval_only — so a partial fix addressing only one control leaves the other exposed.	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Sequence remediation so both the PO-before-order check and the dual-approval gate are addressed at the same order-entry control point.	Head of Procurement

7 Appendix — traceability matrix

Each pain point traced through to the recommendation, opportunity, expected outcome and horizon that addresses it.

PAIN POINT	SUMMARY	SEVERITY	RECOMMENDATION	OPPORTUNITY	EXPECTED OUTCOME	HORIZON
7 purchase orders worth EUR 557,000 – 12 percent of total PO value – were released on a single approval despite the policy requiring Category Manager and Finance sign-off above EUR 50,000.	Single-approval releases breach the EUR 50,000 dual-approval rule across EUR 557,000 of spend.	High	Convert the dual-approval policy rule into an enforced system gate that blocks release of any above-threshold order lacking a second approval.	Restore control over 12 percent of PO value currently bypassing the mandated second review.	single_appr oval_only status eliminated for above-threshold orders; bypassing value driven toward zero.	Near-term
3 maverick orders worth EUR 216,000 (4.7 percent of total PO value) were placed without a prior purchase order, against an explicit no-maverick-spend policy.	Maverick spend of EUR 216,000 violates the PO-before-order requirement .	High	Require a raised purchase order as a precondition to ordering so spend cannot be committed before the PO exists.	Close 4.7 percent of total PO value currently committed outside the controlled process.	Maverick order count and value driven toward zero.	Near-term

PAIN POINT	SUMMARY	SEVERITY	RECOMMENDATION	OPPORTUNITY	EXPECTED OUTCOME	HORIZON
All 3 maverick orders are also single_app roval_only, so the same lines breach two distinct controls simultaneously.	Overlapping breaches concentrate risk on the same 3 orders.	High	Address the PO-before-order check and the dual-approval gate together at the order-entry control point.	Eliminate compounded exposure where one order fails two controls.	Dual-breach overlap reduced to zero.	Near-term
The policy never names an exception or remediation owner, leaving breaches without defined accountability.	Undefined ownership leaves the control framework incomplete.	Medium	Amend the procurement policy to assign an accountable role and remediation path for each breach type.	Establish clear ownership so detected breaches are consistently resolved.	Full control-ownership coverage across breach types.	Near-term

REPORT 04 OF 06

AI Opportunity Portfolio

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

REPORT REFERENCE	Report 04 of 06
CLIENT	Acme Manufacturing
DOMAIN	Procure-to-Pay
PREPARED BY	AuroPro · Autonomous Discovery Platform
CLASSIFICATION	Confidential

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1	Portfolio at a glance
2	Opportunities in detail

AI Opportunity Portfolio

The recommended interventions in full — what the problem is, how the process changes, and what it delivers.

1 Portfolio at a glance

OPPORTUNITY	PATTERN	WHO IT SERVES	KNOWLEDGE SOURCES	EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR
High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off	HITL Workflow	Requester, First-line approver / budget holder, Finance approver, Audit and compliance	Procurement policy (dual-approval and high-value definitions), Purchase order export (approval and release history)	No high-value purchase order can be released to a supplier without both the first approval and the mandatory ...
Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy	HITL Workflow	Requester / budget holder, Procurement reviewer, Accounts payable, Procurement governance	Procurement policy (PO-before-commitment requirement, spend thresholds and approval hierarchy), Purchase-order export (record used to match invoices and detect missing POs)	Spend is committed only after an approved purchase order exists; any commitment made without one is detected ...
Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches	HITL Workflow	Exception & Remediation Owner, Procurement / Finance Management, Approvers, Audit	Procurement policy controls and approval thresholds, Purchase order export population	Every detected control breach is routed to a named owner, adjudicated with a documented remediation decision,...

2 Opportunities in detail

High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off HITL WORKFLOW

The procurement policy requires high-value purchase orders to receive a second, mandatory Finance sign-off before they are released to a supplier. Evidence in the purchase order export shows orders being released on a single approval, meaning the Finance control point defined in the policy is being bypassed in practice. This opportunity introduces a human-in-the-loop approval gate that holds any order meeting the high-

value criteria until the required Finance approver has signed off, closing the gap between the documented control and day-to-day execution. The intent is not to add friction to routine, low-value buying but to ensure the specific orders the policy already designates for dual control cannot proceed without it.

TODAY

1. Requisition raised

Requester · Procurement system

A staff member raises a purchase requisition for goods or services and submits it for approval.

2. Single approval applied

Line manager / budget holder · Procurement system

The order receives one approval. Where the value meets the high-value threshold, the policy requires an additional Finance sign-off, but the workflow does not enforce this second step.

The mandatory Finance sign-off step is not enforced by the system control

High-value orders are not consistently flagged for the second approval

Approver may not be aware the order crosses the high-value threshold

3. Purchase order released

Procurement system · Procurement system

The order is released to the supplier on the strength of the single approval, before any Finance review has occurred.

Order is committed to a supplier without the mandatory dual control

No automated hold prevents release of an unapproved high-value order

4. Exception detected after the fact

Finance / audit

The missing Finance sign-off is only identified retrospectively, if at all, during reconciliation or audit — after the commitment has already been made.

Control breach is detected late, after spend is committed

Remediation is manual and reactive



WITH THE CHANGE

1. Requisition raised

Requester · Procurement system

A staff member raises a purchase requisition and submits it for approval, unchanged from today.

2. High-value check at first approval

Procurement system · Procurement system

At the point of first approval the order value is automatically evaluated against the high-value criterion defined in the procurement policy.

3. Mandatory Finance approval gate

Finance approver · Procurement system

Orders meeting the high-value criterion are routed to a Finance approver and held. The order cannot be released until the Finance sign-off is recorded, enforcing the dual control the policy already mandates.

4. Controlled release

Procurement system · Procurement system

Once both the first approval and the Finance sign-off are present, the order is released to the supplier. Orders below the threshold continue to flow on a single approval with no added friction.

5. Exception logging and reporting

Finance / audit

Any attempt to release a high-value order without Finance sign-off is blocked and logged, giving Finance a forward-looking control rather than a retrospective clean-up.

Business impact. The policy designates high-value purchase orders for mandatory dual approval, with a second Finance sign-off acting as the control on significant spend. The purchase order export shows orders being released on a single approval, which means this control is being bypassed and high-value spend is being committed to suppliers without the review the organisation has decided is necessary. Each bypassed order represents an uncontrolled financial commitment, an audit and compliance exposure against the organisation's own stated policy, and a missed opportunity to catch errors, duplicate orders, or unintended spend before money is committed. Enforcing the gate converts a reactive, after-the-fact detection process into a preventive control applied at the moment of release.

How we get there: The impact is established qualitatively from two grounded sources: the procurement policy, which mandates Finance sign-off for high-value orders, and the purchase order export, which evidences orders released on a single approval. No verified count, value, or percentage of affected orders was supplied to this section, so the magnitude is described directionally rather than quantified to avoid inventing figures.

How it's delivered. Implement a system-enforced approval gate within the existing procurement workflow. At the first approval step the order value is compared against the

high-value criterion from the procurement policy; orders that meet it are placed on hold and routed to a designated Finance approver, and the procurement system is configured so that release is impossible until the Finance sign-off is recorded. Existing approval and routing capability in the procurement system should be reused where possible rather than rebuilt. A blocked-release event log should be added to give Finance visibility of any bypass attempts. Roll out in a controlled manner: validate the threshold logic against historical orders from the export, pilot with a single category or business unit, then extend organisation-wide.

Who uses it. Requester, First-line approver / budget holder, Finance approver, Audit and compliance

Expected behaviour. No high-value purchase order can be released to a supplier without both the first approval and the mandatory Finance sign-off recorded. Below-threshold orders continue to release on a single approval. Any bypass attempt is blocked and logged.

Escalation & human fallback. If a Finance approver is unavailable, the held order should escalate to a delegated approver rather than release uncontrolled. Repeated bypass attempts or threshold misclassifications should be surfaced to Finance for review.

Sources. Procurement policy (dual-approval and high-value definitions), Purchase order export (approval and release history) **Formats.** Purchase order export

Connects: Procurement system approval workflow and routing, Order-value data source for the high-value check, Exception/audit logging for blocked releases

Success looks like:

- Zero high-value purchase orders released without a recorded Finance sign-off
- Proportion of high-value orders correctly routed to the Finance gate
- Reduction in control breaches identified retrospectively during reconciliation and audit
- Time from first approval to Finance sign-off for high-value orders
- Number of blocked-release attempts logged and resolved

Dependencies: Independent — can start immediately. Prerequisite for Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches.

Risks:

- The high-value threshold must be configured to match the procurement policy precisely; a mismatch could let orders through or over-route low-value orders
- Finance approver capacity could create a release bottleneck if sign-off turnaround is not managed

- Requesters may attempt to split orders to stay below the threshold, requiring a complementary control
- Incomplete or inconsistent value data on orders could cause the high-value check to misclassify orders
- Change resistance from teams accustomed to single-approval release

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy

HITL WORKFLOW

Maverick spend — purchases committed with suppliers before a purchase order (PO) is raised and approved — undermines the procurement policy's control framework. When invoices arrive against commitments that were never sanctioned through the PO workflow, the organisation loses the ability to enforce spend thresholds, approval hierarchies and budget checks at the point of commitment. This opportunity establishes a human-in-the-loop control that detects off-policy commitments, routes them to an accountable reviewer, and either retrospectively validates or escalates them, while feeding the pattern back to prevent recurrence. The aim is to move enforcement from after-the-fact invoice reconciliation to the point at which spend is committed, restoring the policy's intended "no PO, no commitment" discipline.

TODAY

1. Spend committed with supplier

Requester / budget holder · Email / phone / supplier portal (off-system)

A staff member contacts a supplier and commits to a purchase directly, agreeing scope and price without first raising a purchase order in the procurement system.

Commitment is made before any approval or budget check

No PO number exists to anchor downstream controls

Policy requirement to raise a PO before committing is bypassed

2. Invoice arrives without matching PO

Accounts payable · Accounts payable / finance system

The supplier invoice is received and AP attempts to match it to a purchase order, but no PO exists because the commitment was made off-policy.

No three-way match possible

Invoice stalls pending investigation

Spend already incurred and cannot be unwound

3. Retrospective PO raised to clear invoice

Procurement / AP · Procurement system

To release payment, a purchase order is raised after the fact so the invoice can be matched, effectively rubber-stamping a commitment that never passed pre-commitment approval.

Approval becomes a formality rather than a control

Off-policy pattern is not recorded or escalated

No accountability assigned for the breach



WITH THE CHANGE

1. Commitment validated against PO record at point of invoice

Detection control · Procurement / finance integration

Incoming invoices and supplier commitments are checked against the purchase-order record to identify any spend committed without a pre-existing, approved PO.

Requires reliable linkage between invoice and PO data

2. Off-policy commitment routed for human review

Procurement reviewer · Review workflow / queue

Any detected maverick commitment is routed to an accountable reviewer with the policy clause it breaches and the spend detail, for a decision to validate retrospectively or escalate.

Reviewer needs clear policy criteria to decide consistently

3. Decision recorded and pattern fed back

Procurement reviewer / governance · Governance reporting

The reviewer's decision is logged against the requester and supplier so repeat off-policy behaviour is visible, and the case feeds reporting that drives corrective action and prevention.

Feedback loop must reach budget holders to change behaviour

Business impact. Maverick spend committed without a purchase order means the procurement policy's approval and budget controls are applied only after money is already committed, when they can no longer prevent overspend or off-contract buying. Establishing a human-in-the-loop control at the point of commitment restores enforcement of the policy, makes off-policy commitments visible to an accountable reviewer, and creates a record that deters repeat breaches. Because the supporting figures could not be independently verified from the provided facts, the impact is described qualitatively and should be quantified once the off-policy commitment volume is measured.

How we get there: No verified numeric values for maverick-spend volume, value or breach counts were supplied among the verified facts; therefore no measured figures are stated and the impact is expressed qualitatively, anchored to the policy requirement to raise a PO before committing spend and to the purchase-order record used for matching.

How it's delivered. Introduce a detection step that compares incoming invoices and supplier commitments against the purchase-order record to flag spend committed without a prior approved PO, then route each flagged case to an accountable procurement reviewer with the relevant policy clause and spend detail. The reviewer retrospectively validates legitimate exceptions or escalates breaches, and every decision is logged against the requester and supplier so repeat behaviour becomes visible. Pair the control with a feedback loop to budget holders that reinforces the policy's "PO before commitment" rule. Start with detection and review on the highest-risk commitment types, then extend coverage and tighten prevention as the pattern data matures.

Who uses it. Requester / budget holder, Procurement reviewer, Accounts payable, Procurement governance

Expected behaviour. Spend is committed only after an approved purchase order exists; any commitment made without one is detected at the point of invoice, routed to an accountable reviewer, dispositioned against policy, and recorded so repeat breaches are prevented.

Escalation & human fallback. Off-policy commitments above the agreed escalation threshold, or repeat breaches by the same requester or supplier, are escalated to procurement governance rather than retrospectively validated.

Sources. Procurement policy (PO-before-commitment requirement, spend thresholds and approval hierarchy), Purchase-order export (record used to match invoices and detect missing POs)

Formats. Purchase-order export, Procurement policy document

Connects: Procurement system / purchase-order record, Accounts payable / finance system for invoice matching

Success looks like:

- Reduction in invoices arriving without a matching, pre-approved purchase order
- Reduction in retrospective POs raised solely to clear an already-committed invoice
- Proportion of off-policy commitments detected and routed to human review rather than discovered at payment
- Reduction in repeat off-policy commitments by the same requester or supplier

Dependencies: Independent — can start immediately. Prerequisite for Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches.

Risks:

- Reliable linkage between invoice data and the purchase-order record is required for accurate detection; gaps would let maverick spend pass undetected
- Without clear, consistently applied policy criteria, reviewers may retrospectively validate breaches and weaken the control
- If the feedback loop does not reach budget holders, detection alone will not change commitment behaviour
- Treating retrospective PO creation as routine could entrench the breach rather than correct it

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

Address: No defined exception or remediation owner for control breaches

HITL WORKFLOW

The procurement control environment currently lacks a defined owner accountable for handling exceptions and remediating control breaches. When a purchase order violates a policy control — for example, exceeding an approval threshold, missing a required approval step, or being split to evade limits — there is no named role responsible for catching the breach, deciding on the appropriate response, and driving the remediation to closure. As a result, breaches are detected inconsistently (if at all), no audit trail of the resolution is maintained, and the same control gaps recur. This opportunity establishes a human-in-the-loop exception and remediation workflow with a clearly assigned owner, a defined intake-to-closure path, and a documented decision record for every breach.

TODAY

1. Breach occurs without detection trigger

Requisitioner / Approver · Procurement / PO system

A purchase order is raised or approved in a way that violates a procurement control. Because no control monitoring is tied to a responsible owner, the breach is not systematically flagged at the point it happens.

No automated or assigned check links the breach to a person

Breach may pass unnoticed into the approved PO population

2. Ad hoc, unowned discovery

Finance / Audit (informal) · Email / spreadsheets

If a breach is noticed at all, it is found informally — during an unrelated review, a finance query, or an audit — rather than through a defined exception process. There is no single role that owns the question of what to do next.

Detection depends on chance rather than a defined control

No standard intake point for raising an exception

3. No remediation decision or closure

Unassigned · None

Because no owner is accountable, breaches are not formally adjudicated, remediated, or closed. There is no decision record, no corrective action, and no mechanism to prevent recurrence.

No documented remediation decision

No audit trail of resolution

Same control gaps recur



WITH THE CHANGE

1. Breach flagged into a defined intake queue

Control monitoring (system-assisted) · Exception workflow

A control breach — threshold exceedance, missing approval, or split order — is routed into a single exception intake queue the moment it is detected, creating a traceable case record.

False positives if control logic is mis-tuned

2. Named exception owner triages and decides

Exception & Remediation Owner · Exception workflow

A designated exception/remediation owner reviews each case, classifies severity, and records a remediation decision — accept with justification, correct the order, or escalate. Every decision is captured in a structured record.

Owner backlog if case volume exceeds capacity

3. Remediation tracked to documented closure

Exception & Remediation Owner · Exception workflow

The owner drives corrective action to completion, and the case is closed only with a documented outcome. Recurring breach patterns feed back into control tuning and policy updates.

Closure quality depends on owner discipline and review

Business impact. Without a defined exception or remediation owner, control breaches in the purchase order population go unadjudicated and unclosed, leaving the organisation exposed to uncontrolled spend, audit findings, and recurring policy violations. Assigning a single accountable owner with a defined intake-to-closure workflow converts breaches from silent, unmanaged events into tracked cases with documented decisions and an audit trail. Because no breach-volume or financial-exposure figures are present in the

verified facts provided, the impact is described qualitatively rather than quantified, to avoid asserting unverified numbers.

How we get there: No verified numeric values (breach counts, exposure amounts, or order volumes) were supplied for OPP3, so no measured figures are stated. Impact is expressed qualitatively and grounded in the procurement policy controls and the purchase order export population.

How it's delivered. Codify policy controls into detectable rules, validate against the purchase order export, define the owner role and decision rights, pilot on historical breaches, then operate live with documented closure and feedback into control tuning.

Who uses it. Exception & Remediation Owner, Procurement / Finance Management, Approvers, Audit

Expected behaviour. Every detected control breach is routed to a named owner, adjudicated with a documented remediation decision, and closed with an audit trail; recurring patterns are fed back into control and policy improvement.

Escalation & human fallback. Cases above a defined severity threshold or those the owner cannot resolve within the target SLA are escalated to procurement/finance management for decision.

Sources. Procurement policy controls and approval thresholds, Purchase order export population

Formats. Procurement policy document, Purchase order export

Connects: Procurement / PO system, Exception case-management or workflow tooling

Success looks like:

- Percentage of detected control breaches assigned to a named owner (target: all)
- Percentage of breach cases closed with a documented remediation decision
- Time from breach detection to case closure
- Reduction in recurring breaches of the same control type over time
- Audit-trail completeness for adjudicated exceptions

Dependencies: Requires High-value purchase orders released on a single approval, bypassing mandatory Finance sign-off, Address: Maverick spend committed without a purchase order, in breach of policy first.

Risks:

- Owner role becomes a bottleneck if breach volume exceeds capacity
- Poorly tuned control logic generates false positives that erode owner trust in the queue
- Without management mandate, owner decisions may be overridden or ignored
- Closure quality depends on owner discipline and review, risking superficial sign-off

Where this comes from: Procurement Policy and Purchase Order Export

REPORT 05 OF 06

Transformation Roadmap

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

REPORT REFERENCE	Report 05 of 06
CLIENT	Acme Manufacturing
DOMAIN	Procure-to-Pay
PREPARED BY	AuroPro · Autonomous Discovery Platform
CLASSIFICATION	Confidential

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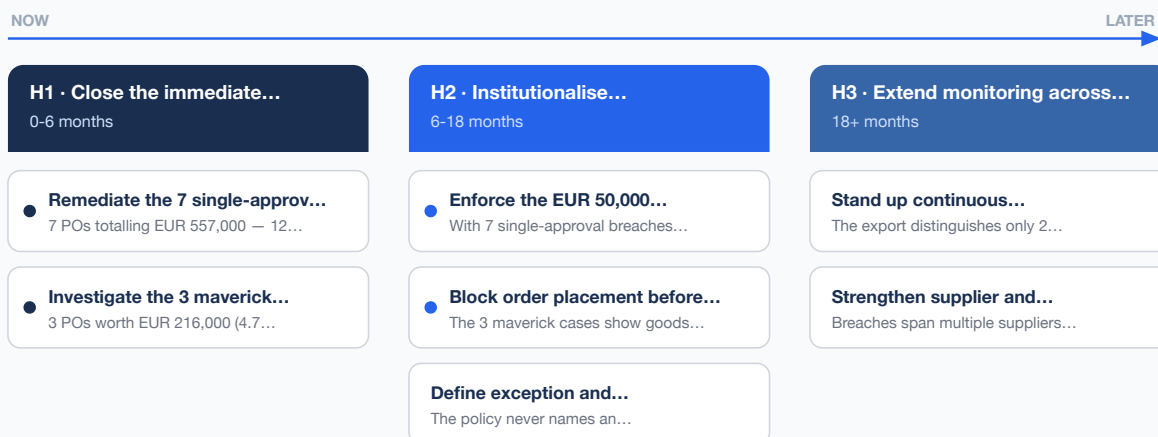
1	Implementation roadmap
2	Horizon detail
3	How the work connects
4	Planning assumptions

Transformation Roadmap

Sequenced across three horizons, aimed at a Control-first remediation direction.

1 Implementation roadmap

THE PLAN ACROSS THREE HORIZONS (NOW → LATER)



2 Horizon detail

H1 — Close the immediate approval and maverick-spend control gaps (0-6 months)

- **Remediate the 7 single-approval-only purchase orders above the EUR 50,000 threshold **opportunity**** — 7 POs totalling EUR 557,000 — 12 percent of total PO value — were released on a single approval, yet policy states any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager AND a second approval from Finance before release. The export confirms these sit at amounts of 54,000 through 120,000, all above 50,000, making each a clear breach to review and back-approve.
- **Investigate the 3 maverick purchase orders raised after goods were ordered **opportunity**** — 3 POs worth EUR 216,000 (4.7 percent of total PO value) were raised with po_before_order=no, contradicting the rule that all purchase orders must be raised in the procurement system before goods are ordered and that maverick spend is not permitted under any circumstances. All 3 are also single-approval-only, so this is the highest-risk concentration in the dataset and warrants priority review.

H2 — Institutionalise preventive approval and ordering controls (6-18 months)

- **Enforce the EUR 50,000 dual-approval threshold as a system gate** opportunity
 - With 7 single-approval breaches already evidenced and a documented threshold requiring a second Finance approval above EUR 50,000, a system-enforced gate prevents recurrence rather than relying on after-the-fact detection. The largest single PO in the dataset reaches EUR 150,000, underscoring the value at stake when the gate is absent.
- **Block order placement before a purchase order exists** opportunity — The 3 maverick cases show goods can currently be ordered ahead of a PO. A preventive control that requires a raised PO before ordering directly addresses the policy rule and the 4.7 percent of value currently bypassing it.
- **Define exception and remediation ownership** — The policy never names an exception or remediation owner, leaving breaches without a clear accountable party. Establishing ownership is a prerequisite for sustaining both preventive controls.

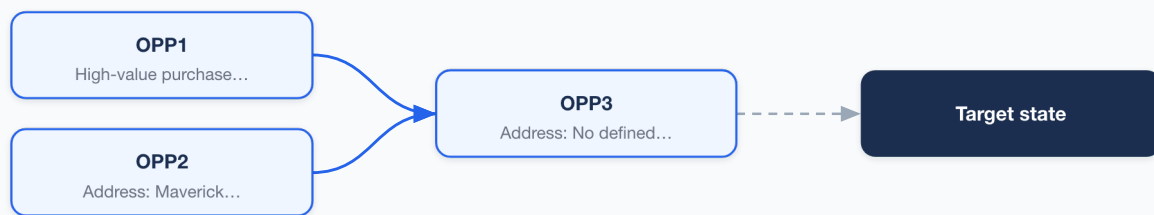
H3 — Extend monitoring across the full purchase-order population (18+ months)

- **Stand up continuous compliance monitoring across all approval statuses** — The export distinguishes only 2 approval_status values (approved at 226 rows and single_approval_only at 7 rows) and 230 compliant versus 3 maverick orders. Ongoing monitoring across the full population sustains the H1-H2 gains and surfaces new breaches as volume grows.
- **Strengthen supplier and category-level spend governance** — Breaches span multiple suppliers and categories — including Components, Raw Materials, Packaging and Logistics — so extending governance beyond individual POs to supplier and category patterns reduces the chance of concentrated risk re-emerging.

3 How the work connects

The enabling relationships between the opportunities — what unlocks what.

HOW THE OPPORTUNITIES ENABLE ONE ANOTHER



Arrows show enabling relationships; all paths lead to the target state.

4 Planning assumptions

The forward-looking elements of this roadmap — dates, owners, service levels, targets, cadence and sequence — are planning assumptions, not measured findings. They are shown here explicitly so they can be confirmed before delivery.

PLANNING ASSUMPTION — CONFIRM BEFORE DELIVERY

These forward-looking items are recommendations, not measured facts.

TYPE	ASSUMPTION	BASIS
OWNERSHIP	Assign a named remediation owner (e.g., Finance control lead) to review and clear the 7 single-approval POs, as the policy currently names no exception or remediation owner.	Quote: 'second approval: count 0, no matching lines — policy never names an exception/remediation owner'
SEQUENCING	Prioritise the 3 maverick POs (EUR 216,000) that are also single-approval-only as first-pass remediation, given they carry overlapping breaches.	Maverick POs that are also <code>single_approval_only</code> (count) = 3.0; Total EUR value of maverick POs = 216000.0
TARGET	Introduce a system control that blocks release to suppliers for any PO above EUR 50,000 until a second Finance approval is recorded.	Policy: 'Any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager AND a second approval from Finance before it is released to the supplier.'
OWNERSHIP	An exception and remediation owner for purchase orders above EUR 50,000 that lack a second approval is to be designated.	Export second-approval note: count 0, no matching lines — policy never names an exception/remediation owner.

TYPE	ASSUMPTION	BASIS
TARGET	The EUR 50,000 two-approval threshold (Category Manager plus Finance) is the operative control point to be confirmed for ongoing routing.	<i>Policy point 2: any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires approval from the Category Manager and a second approval from Finance before release.</i>
OWNERSHIP	Assign a named exception and remediation owner (e.g. a Finance control lead) accountable for reviewing and closing out single-approval and maverick POs.	<i>Policy never names an exception/remediation owner; second approval count 0, no matching lines</i>
TARGET	Configure the procurement system to hard-block release of any PO above EUR 50,000 until both Category Manager and Finance approvals are recorded.	<i>Policy requires dual approval above EUR 50,000; 7 single_approval_only POs all exceeded this threshold</i>
TARGET	Introduce a preventive control that prevents a PO being raised after goods are ordered, removing the maverick-spend path.	<i>3 POs recorded po_before_order = no despite policy prohibiting maverick spend</i>
CADENCE	Establish a recurring review of single_approval_only and po_before_order = no exceptions to confirm breaches are remediated.	<i>7 single-approval and 3 maverick rows currently sit in 'approved' status with no remediation path</i>
OWNERSHIP	Remediation ownership for the 7 single-approval-only POs and the 3 maverick POs is currently unassigned and will need to be designated before corrective review can begin.	<i>The procurement policy names no exception or remediation owner for second-approval breaches (purchase-order-export note: 'policy never names an exception/remediation owner').</i>
SEQUENCING	A retrospective review of all 7 single_approval_only POs should be prioritised ahead of broader control work, given they represent the verified 12 percent of value that bypassed second approval.	<i>7 single_approval_only POs totalling EUR 557,000 (12 percent of total PO value), grounded in procurement-policy and purchase-order-export.</i>
TARGET	A target threshold of zero POs above EUR 50,000 released without a documented Finance second approval should be adopted as the control standard.	<i>Procurement policy requires Category Manager AND Finance approval for any PO above EUR 50,000 before release to the supplier.</i>

TYPE	ASSUMPTION	BASIS
TARGET	A target of zero maverick (po_before_order = no) transactions should be set, consistent with the policy that maverick spend is not permitted under any circumstances.	<i>Procurement policy prohibits ordering without a purchase order; export currently shows 3 such POs worth EUR 216,000.</i>
CADENCE	A recurring monitoring cadence should be established to re-run the single_approval_only and po_before_order checks against future exports.	<i>Export already distinguishes approval_status (approved 226, single_approval_only 7) and po_before_order (yes 230, no 3), so the same checks can be repeated.</i>
TIMING	H1 remediation of the 7 single-approval-only POs should complete within the first 6 months given the concentrated, clearly evidenced exposure.	<i>7 POs flagged single_approval_only totalling EUR 557,000 (12 percent of total PO value)</i>
OWNERSHIP	A remediation owner and exception owner should be formally designated, since the policy currently names none.	<i>Policy quote: second approval count 0, no matching lines — policy never names an exception/remediation owner</i>
SERVICE LEVEL	Define a service-level target for reviewing and back-approving flagged single-approval POs (e.g., resolution within a fixed number of business days of detection).	<i>7 single-approval-only POs above the EUR 50,000 threshold</i>
TARGET	Adopt the documented EUR 50,000 dual-approval threshold as the enforced system gate value.	<i>Policy: any purchase order above EUR 50,000 requires Category Manager AND second Finance approval before release</i>
CADENCE	Run the full-population compliance scan on a recurring cadence (e.g., monthly) once H1-H2 controls are live.	<i>approval_status distinct: approved (226), single_approval_only (7); po_before_order distinct: yes (230), no (3)</i>
SEQUENCING	Sequence immediate breach remediation (H1) before building system-enforced preventive gates (H2), with continuous monitoring (H3) last.	<i>3 maverick POs are also single_approval_only, concentrating EUR 216,000 of highest-risk spend that warrants first attention</i>
TARGET	The exact monetary threshold defining a high-value order should be confirmed against the current procurement policy before configuration.	<i>Procurement policy mandates Finance sign-off for high-value orders</i>

TYPE	ASSUMPTION	BASIS
OWNERSHIP	A named Finance approver role (with cover/delegation) should own the sign-off gate.	<i>Policy requires a Finance sign-off step</i>
SERVICE LEVEL	A target turnaround time should be set for Finance sign-off on held high-value orders to avoid release bottlenecks.	<i>Policy-mandated Finance approval step is being added to the release path</i>
SEQUENCING	Threshold logic should be validated against historical orders before pilot, then rolled out by category or business unit before organisation-wide enablement.	<i>Purchase order export provides historical orders to validate against</i>
CADENCE	Blocked-release exception logs should be reviewed on a regular cadence by Finance.	<i>Policy control is being moved from retrospective to preventive enforcement</i>
OWNERSHIP	Assign an accountable procurement reviewer (or role) as owner of the off-policy commitment review queue.	<i>Policy requires a PO before commitment; review step routes breaches to a named reviewer</i>
SERVICE LEVEL	Define a target response time for reviewing and dispositioning each flagged off-policy commitment.	<i>Off-policy commitments are routed to human review in the after-state process</i>
TARGET	Set a threshold spend value above which an off-policy commitment is automatically escalated rather than retrospectively validated.	<i>Procurement policy defines spend thresholds and approval hierarchy</i>
CADENCE	Establish a recurring governance review of detected maverick-spend patterns by requester and supplier.	<i>Decisions are logged and fed back to drive corrective action</i>
SEQUENCING	Phase rollout starting with highest-risk commitment types before extending full coverage.	<i>Implementation begins with detection and review on highest-risk commitments</i>
OWNERSHIP	Appoint a single named Exception & Remediation Owner accountable for adjudicating and closing all procurement control breaches.	<i>Procurement policy defines controls but assigns no breach-remediation owner</i>

TYPE	ASSUMPTION	BASIS
SERVICE LEVEL	Set a target resolution SLA (e.g. high-severity breaches adjudicated within a defined number of business days) once baseline case volume is known.	<i>No defined intake-to-closure path exists today</i>
CADENCE	Run a periodic (e.g. monthly) review of recurring breach patterns to feed control tuning and policy updates.	<i>Recurring breaches currently go unaddressed due to no owner</i>
TARGET	Define severity thresholds that determine accept-vs-correct-vs-escalate handling, calibrated against the procurement policy approval limits.	<i>Procurement policy approval thresholds</i>
SEQUENCING	Pilot the workflow on historical breaches first, then sequence into live operation after validation.	<i>Controls validated against the existing purchase order export</i>

REPORT 06 OF 06

Supporting Artefacts

Procure-to-Pay · Acme Manufacturing

REPORT REFERENCE	Report 06 of 06
CLIENT	Acme Manufacturing
DOMAIN	Procure-to-Pay
PREPARED BY	AuroPro · Autonomous Discovery Platform
CLASSIFICATION	Confidential

Contents

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2	Success metrics framework
3	System & data-flow map

Supporting Artefacts

Reference material behind this assessment.

1 Source provenance

Every figure in this assessment is computed from the sources below and traces back to them.

SOURCE	TYPE	WHAT IT IS	FINDINGS IT SUPPORTED
Purchase Order Export	System export	your Purchase Order Export	F1, F2, F3
Procurement Policy	Process documentation	your Procurement Policy	F1, F2, F3

2 Success metrics framework

How the impact of the recommended interventions should be measured once live — the dimension, what it means, and the target to hold delivery to.

METRIC	DEFINITION	TARGET
Dual-approval compliance rate for high-value POs	Share of purchase orders above the EUR 50,000 policy threshold that carry both Category Manager and Finance approval before release, measured against the single_approval_only population (currently 7 POs, EUR 557,000).	Increase toward full compliance; drive single_approval_only count to zero for above-threshold orders
Value bypassing second approval	Total EUR value and percentage of total PO value released on a single approval (currently EUR 557,000, 12 percent of total PO value).	Decrease the bypassing value and its 12 percent share toward zero
Maverick spend rate	Count and EUR value of purchase orders where po_before_order = no, expressed against total PO value (currently 3 POs, EUR 216,000, 4.7 percent of total PO value).	Decrease toward zero maverick orders
Dual-breach overlap	Count of orders that are simultaneously maverick and single_approval_only (currently 3 of 3 maverick orders).	Eliminate the overlap by closing both controls at the order-entry point

METRIC	DEFINITION	TARGET
Control ownership coverage	Share of policy control breaches that have a named accountable role for exception handling and remediation, addressing the documented gap that the policy never names an exception/remediation owner.	Increase to full coverage — every breach type mapped to an accountable role

3 System & data-flow map

The systems view of the same domain — which business systems the process touches and how data moves between them.

A full technical trace of every figure in this assessment is available to your data team on request.